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Correct Answer

Next Q

Practice Exam - 1

Question 93 of 117



A 72-year-old woman returns to the office following a recent 4-day hospitalization for worsening heart failure. She lost 15 pounds with IV furosemide treatment and was discharged home. She has Type 2 diabetes and sleep apnea for which she wears CPAP nightly for a few hours. Medications: amlodipine 10 mg, metoprolol 50 mg, furosemide 80 mg, dapagliflozin 10 mg, metformin 1000 mg. On exam, BP 130/80, JVP 10 cm H₂O, clear lungs, regular heart rhythm, normal S1 and S2 with a soft systolic murmur, no hepatomegaly or lower extremity edema.

Which of the following is the best next step in her management?

A. Switch dapagliflozin to empagliflozin

B. Switch metformin to tirzepatide

C. Start spironolactone 25 mg

D. Switch furosemide to torsemide

E. Start acetazolamide

Commentary

Testing Point: The Board-certified AHFTC specialist should appropriately optimize medical therapy in a heart failure patient with preserved ejection fraction.

Correct Answer: C. Start spironolactone 25 mg

Rationale: The best next step is starting spironolactone. In selected patients with HFpEF, MRAs may reduce heart failure hospitalization risk. The TOPCAT trial demonstrated reduced HF hospitalizations with spironolactone, and the 2022 AHA/ACC/HFSA HF guideline provides a Class IIb recommendation for MRA use in HFpEF to reduce hospitalization.

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